

NCIE Programme Framework

NCIE PROGRAMME FRAMEWORK

The **National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE) Programme Framework** provides an integrated structure for the design, delivery, management, monitoring and continuous improvement of NCIE's programmes and institutional initiatives.

The framework is intended to create a consistent pathway through which **students, youth, innovators, aspiring entrepreneurs, educational institutions, faculty members and partner organisations** can progress from awareness and learning to **skill development, innovation, leadership, entrepreneurship, incubation and ecosystem engagement**.

NCIE programmes may be delivered through **online, offline, hybrid, institutional, regional and seminar-based formats**, depending on programme objectives, participant requirements, institutional arrangements and available resources.

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1. Programme Framework Objectives

The NCIE Programme Framework aims to:

- Promote innovation and creative problem-solving.
- Develop technical, digital, professional and entrepreneurial skills.
- Encourage entrepreneurship and startup-oriented thinking.
- Develop youth leadership and professional capabilities.
- Strengthen innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems within educational institutions.
- Facilitate mentorship, incubation and appropriate ecosystem linkages.
- Promote industry–academia engagement.
- Support institutional capacity building.
- Provide structured opportunities for practical learning and project development.
- Establish measurable programme outcomes and impact.

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2. NCIE Programme Architecture

NCIE's programmes are organised into interconnected programme streams:

A. Student & Youth Development

- Student Innovation Programmes
- Internships
- Fellowships
- Leadership Development
- Scholarship & Student Support Initiatives
- Career and Employability Development

B. Innovation Development

- Innovation Programmes
- Design Thinking
- Innovation Challenges
- Hackathons
- Competitions
- Prototype Development
- Technology Innovation

C. Entrepreneurship & Startup Development

- Entrepreneurship Development Programmes
- Startup Orientation
- Startup Validation
- Business Model Development
- Startup Mentorship
- Incubation Linkages
- Investor Readiness

D. Technology & Digital Development

- AI & Digital Skills Development
- AI, Business & Startup Innovation
- Innovation & Technology Management
- Emerging Technology Programmes
- Digital Productivity

E. Institutional Development

- Faculty Development
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Support
- Institutional Capacity Building
- Institutional Innovation Programmes

F. Ecosystem & Partnership Development

- Government & Public-Sector Engagement
- Academic Partnerships
- Industry Partnerships
- CSR Partnerships
- Incubator & Accelerator Partnerships
- NGO & Community Partnerships

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3. NCIE Programme Lifecycle

Every programme may follow a structured lifecycle:

NEED IDENTIFICATION



PROGRAMME CONCEPT DEVELOPMENT



OBJECTIVE & OUTCOME DEFINITION



CURRICULUM / PROGRAMME DESIGN



INSTITUTIONAL / PARTNER ENGAGEMENT



RESOURCE PLANNING



REGISTRATION & MOBILISATION



TRAINING / PROGRAMME DELIVERY



PRACTICAL ACTIVITIES



MENTORSHIP & GUIDANCE

↓
ASSESSMENT / VALIDATION
↓
CERTIFICATION / RECOGNITION
↓
ECOSYSTEM LINKAGE
↓
MONITORING & IMPACT ASSESSMENT
↓
REPORTING & PROGRAMME IMPROVEMENT

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4. Programme Development Model

NCIE programmes may be developed using the following sequence:

1. Identify

Identify the needs of the target beneficiaries and participating institutions.

2. Design

Develop programme objectives, curriculum, delivery methodology, duration and assessment framework.

3. Mobilise

Engage eligible participants and institutions through appropriate communication and outreach.

4. Deliver

Provide training, workshops, practical activities, mentoring and project-based learning.

5. Assess

Evaluate participation, learning, project development and programme outcomes.

6. Connect

Where appropriate, connect eligible participants and institutions with

mentors, industry, incubators, accelerators and other relevant ecosystem stakeholders.

7. Measure

Track outputs, outcomes and measurable impact.

8. Improve

Use monitoring and evaluation findings to strengthen future programme cycles.

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5. Programme Delivery Formats

NCIE may use multiple delivery formats depending on programme requirements.

Online

Suitable for:

- Digital learning
- Webinars
- Online classes
- Expert sessions
- Assessments
- Digital mentorship

Offline

Suitable for:

- Classroom training
- Workshops
- Innovation activities
- Institutional programmes
- Practical sessions
- Hackathons

Hybrid

Combines:

ONLINE LEARNING + OFFLINE ACTIVITIES

Suitable for programmes requiring both digital learning and practical institutional engagement.

Seminars & Conferences

Used for:

- Awareness
- Knowledge dissemination
- Expert interaction
- Policy discussions
- Innovation showcases
- Entrepreneurship orientation

Institution-Based Programmes

Delivered through participating:

- Colleges
- Universities
- Schools
- Training institutions
- Innovation centres
- Other eligible organisations

Regional Centre Model

NCIE may establish or utilise appropriate **regional programme centres** to support:

- Local programme delivery
- Institutional outreach
- Trainer coordination
- Mentorship
- Student mobilisation
- Regional innovation activities

6. Training & Learning Framework

NCIE programmes may combine:

THEORY



PRACTICAL LEARNING



PROJECT WORK



MENTORSHIP



ASSESSMENT



APPLICATION

The learning approach may incorporate:

- Lectures
- Workshops
- Case studies
- Demonstrations
- Group activities
- Projects
- Presentations
- Expert interaction
- Problem-solving exercises

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7. Innovation-to-Enterprise Pathway

For innovation and startup-oriented programmes, NCIE may follow:

PROBLEM IDENTIFICATION



IDEA GENERATION



DESIGN & INNOVATION



PROTOTYPE

↓
PROOF OF CONCEPT
↓
VALIDATION
↓
MENTORSHIP
↓
INCUBATION LINKAGE
↓
INVESTOR READINESS
↓
ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT

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8. Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme

The **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam Startup Validation Programme** forms part of the startup and innovation stream.

It may support:

- Idea development
- Prototype development
- Startup validation
- Business model development
- Mentorship
- Incubation linkage
- Investor readiness
- Industry connectivity

For selected eligible startup initiatives, the programme framework may provide **indicative support up to ₹5 lakh**, subject to applicable programme guidelines, selection, evaluation and availability of resources.

Suitable investor-ready ventures may also be facilitated towards potential investor engagement through an **indicative investment pipeline of up to ₹25 crore** across eligible opportunities.

These figures are **indicative programme targets/facilitation**

frameworks and are not guaranteed funding or investment commitments.

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9. Institutional Innovation & Entrepreneurship Framework

NCIE may support eligible colleges and universities in developing stronger innovation and entrepreneurship ecosystems through:

- Innovation Centres
- Incubation Centres
- Innovation Laboratories
- Entrepreneurship Development Cells
- Student innovation programmes
- Startup development activities
- AI and digital innovation initiatives
- Faculty development
- Industry–academia programmes

Potential funding pathways may include eligible **Government programmes, Ministry/Department schemes, CSR partnerships, industry support and other appropriate funding mechanisms.**

Where applicable, institutional funding requirements may be developed in the indicative range of:

₹5 LAKH – ₹25 LAKH

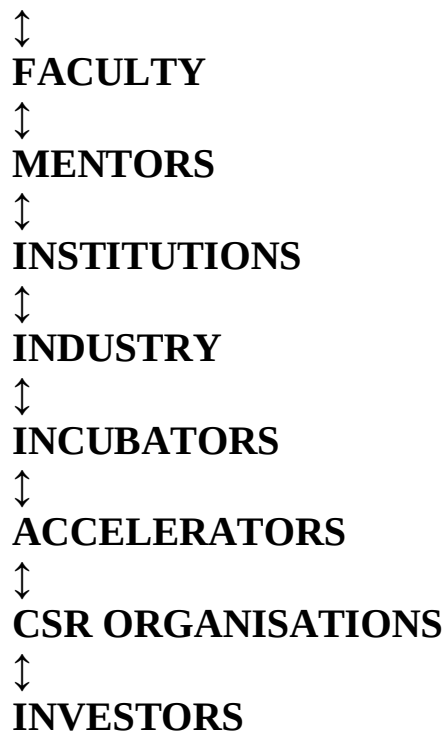
Actual funding remains subject to **eligibility, proposal evaluation, applicable guidelines, availability of funds and approval by the relevant funding organisation.**

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10. Mentorship & Ecosystem Framework

NCIE may establish structured connections among:

STUDENTS



The purpose is to facilitate appropriate opportunities for **knowledge, mentoring, innovation, incubation, industry exposure and entrepreneurship development.**

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11. Institutional Onboarding Framework

Participating institutions may progress through:

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST / APPLICATION



INSTITUTIONAL INFORMATION REVIEW



PROGRAMME DISCUSSION



ELIGIBILITY / REQUIREMENT ASSESSMENT



PROGRAMME PLAN



INSTITUTIONAL COORDINATOR DESIGNATION



ONBOARDING



PROGRAMME IMPLEMENTATION



REPORTING & REVIEW

Where a formal collaboration exists, the relationship should be governed by the applicable **MoU, agreement, approval or programme document**.



12. Trainer & Mentor Framework

NCIE may maintain a pool of appropriately qualified:

- Trainers
- Faculty members
- Subject-matter experts
- Industry professionals
- Entrepreneurs
- Startup mentors
- Technology experts
- Academic experts

Trainer and mentor engagement may consider:

- Relevant qualifications
- Professional experience
- Subject expertise
- Programme requirements
- Availability
- Performance and feedback



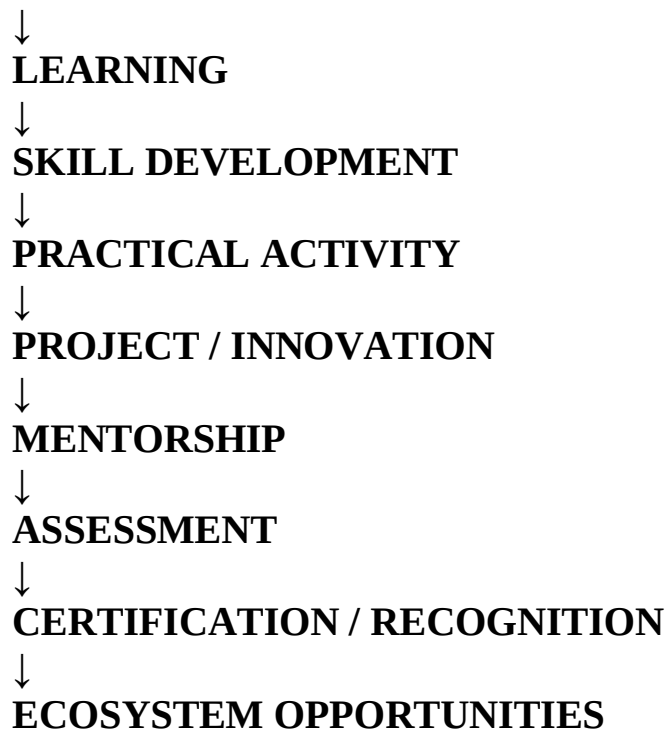
13. Participant Journey

A participant may progress through:

REGISTRATION



ORIENTATION



Participation in later stages may depend on **eligibility, performance, selection and programme-specific criteria.**

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14. Digital Programme Infrastructure

NCIE's digital programme infrastructure may support:

- Online registration
- Participant database
- Attendance management
- Learning resources
- Assessments
- Digital certificates
- Institutional dashboards
- Beneficiary MIS
- Programme reporting
- Project tracking
- Monitoring and evaluation

Appropriate measures should be maintained for **data protection, access control, information security and privacy.**

15. Assessment & Certification Framework

Depending on the programme, assessment may include:

- Attendance
- Knowledge assessments
- Assignments
- Practical activities
- Project work
- Presentations
- Innovation projects
- Mentor evaluation
- Final assessment

Certificates or recognition may be issued according to **programme-specific eligibility and completion requirements**.

Certification should accurately describe the nature of participation and should not imply Government accreditation or recognition unless separately supported by appropriate official documentation.

16. Monitoring & Evaluation

NCIE may monitor programmes through:

Input Indicators

- Resources
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Institutions
- Programme infrastructure

Output Indicators

- Participants registered
- Participants trained
- Institutions onboarded

- Sessions conducted
- Projects completed
- Mentorship sessions delivered

Outcome Indicators

- Skills developed
- Innovation projects progressed
- Startup readiness
- Institutional capacity strengthened
- Industry engagement
- Entrepreneurship participation

Impact Indicators

- Employment or enterprise outcomes where verifiable
- Startup progression
- Institutional innovation outcomes
- Long-term beneficiary outcomes
- Social and economic contribution

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17. Programme Governance

Programme implementation may be supported through:

NCIE GOVERNANCE

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PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT

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PROGRAMME COORDINATORS

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REGIONAL / INSTITUTIONAL COORDINATORS

↓

TRAINERS & MENTORS

↓

PARTICIPANTS

Roles and responsibilities should be documented for each programme.

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18. Programme Quality Framework

NCIE should seek to maintain programme quality through:

- Standardised programme objectives
- Defined curriculum
- Trainer selection
- Mentor quality
- Participant feedback
- Assessment mechanisms
- Documentation
- Periodic review
- Outcome measurement
- Corrective action and continuous improvement

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19. Partnership Framework

NCIE may engage with eligible:

- Educational institutions
- Government and public-sector stakeholders
- Industry
- CSR organisations
- NGOs
- Incubators
- Accelerators
- Startups
- Professional organisations
- Experts and mentors
- Other ecosystem partners

Each partnership should be represented according to the **actual nature and documentary basis of the relationship**.

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20. Financial & Resource Framework

Programme resources may be mobilised through appropriate:

- Programme fees, where applicable
- Institutional contributions
- CSR support
- Sponsorships
- Grants, where eligible
- Government-supported funding opportunities
- Industry partnerships
- Philanthropic support
- Other lawful sources

All funding should be managed through appropriate **financial controls, budgeting, documentation, approvals, utilisation records and reporting mechanisms.**

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21. Transparency & Compliance Principle

NCIE programmes shall be presented transparently, including clear information regarding:

- Programme purpose
- Eligibility
- Fees, if any
- Duration
- Delivery format
- Certification requirements
- Selection criteria
- Funding conditions
- Partnership status
- Government alignment
- Disclaimer regarding non-guaranteed funding or investment

Government policies and national initiatives may be referenced for **thematic alignment**, but such references should not imply Government ownership, endorsement, accreditation or funding unless supported by specific official documentation.

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22. Overall NCIE Programme Framework

**LEARN → SKILL → INNOVATE → LEAD → VALIDATE
→ INCUBATE → CREATE → CONNECT → SCALE →
IMPACT**

The NCIE Programme Framework is designed to establish an integrated ecosystem in which **students and youth acquire knowledge and skills, develop innovative ideas, receive appropriate mentorship, explore entrepreneurship opportunities and connect with relevant institutional and ecosystem stakeholders.**

Through its programmes, NCIE seeks to strengthen **innovation, entrepreneurship, technology, leadership and institutional capabilities**, contributing within its organisational mandate to the broader national development aspiration of **Viksit Bharat @2047**.